RRCRC Connection

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IDES3302B

Research

Blue Sky
Blue Sky research explored what makes a community space active, welcoming, and worth returning to. Four consistent values emerged: visibility, flexibility, accessibility, and interaction. The space should feel open and adaptable, support a range of uses, and encourage people to gather, share skills, and participate.





Context + Field
Contextual and field research revealed that the drama room is currently underused, not because it lacks potential, but because it lacks awareness and clarity. Key barriers included low visibility, weak wayfinding, limited perceived access, and unclear programming information. People are less likely to engage with a space they cannot easily find, understand, or imagine themselves using.

Design System

New spaces
Once storage, these spaces now host workshops, and curated creative tools for any and all activities.

Furniture
New multi use furniture allows the main space to transform its use for a variety of creative and social activities.

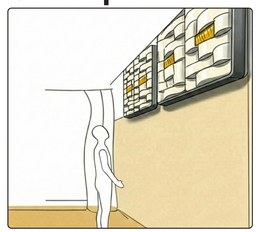
Sharing knowledge
The MUTH provides tools to share in cultural and skilled exchange, with workshops, new collaborative tools, and a focus on sharing.

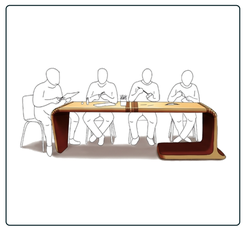


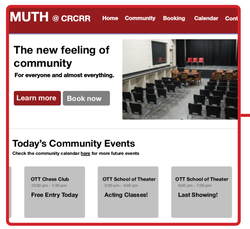
Explore the MUTH
Opening doors
The MUTH is a multi-collaborative, inter generational space to be used by all, regardless of age or experience.

Lighting
New lighting systems are implemented to allow community members to easily adjust the vibe of the space and foster interaction.

Concepts





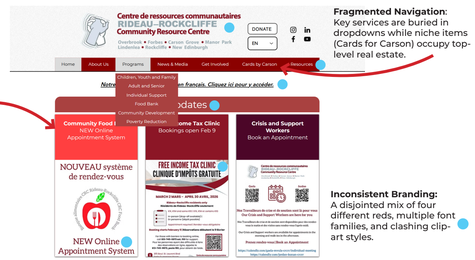


To determine the best path forward, I analyzed the WAV, Arnold, and MUTH Connection concepts through the lens of realistic community implementation. In designing for a low-budget environment, I considered whether each concept could be supported by the community center's existing infrastructure and whether it would naturally improve how users interact with the MUTH space and the community center as a whole. Ultimately, the goal was to identify the solution with the lowest barrier to entry and the greatest potential to increase user engagement, while ensuring the space remains accessible, active, and easy to manage.

Final Direction

Ultimately, designing a standalone site for a single room proved counterproductive and lacked scalability. Instead, the final concept pivoted to a broader, more impactful solution: a comprehensive digital extension for the entire community center. This new platform acts as a centralized digital hub where users can seamlessly connect with people, spaces, groups, and events. By introducing a unified directory, the site allows users to join groups or book spaces like MUTH through a frictionless, intuitive process—eliminating the frustration of traditional booking systems. Above all, the platform prioritizes inclusive design, ensuring the interface is highly accessible and easy to navigate for a highly diverse demographic, from older adults and newcomers to Canada, to digital natives.

Refinement Research | Development

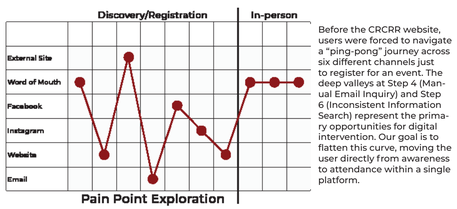


Static "Poster" Layouts: Information is trapped in images, making it unsearchable and inaccessible for screen

Fragmented Navigation: Key services are buried in dropdowns while niche items (Cards for Carson) occupy top-level real estate.

Inconsistent Branding: A disjointed mix of four different reds, multiple font families, and clashing clip-art styles.

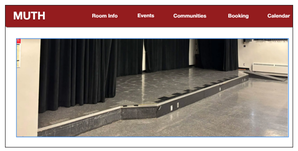
Original Site Issues



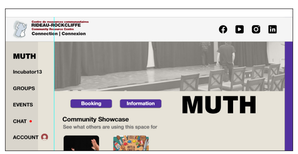
Pain Point Exploration

Before the CRCRR website, users were forced to navigate a "ping-pong" journey across six different channels just to register for an event. The deep valleys at Step 4 (Manual Email Inquiry) and Step 6 (Inconsistent Information Search) represent the primary opportunities for digital intervention. Our goal is to flatten this curve, moving the user directly from awareness to attendance within a single platform.

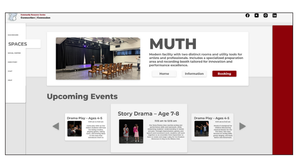
Iteration 1: Visual Foundation
Focused on establishing a "MUTH" sub-brand using the original site's color palette. While visually cohesive, it was functionally limited to a single space, failing to capture the scale of the broader Community Resource Centre.

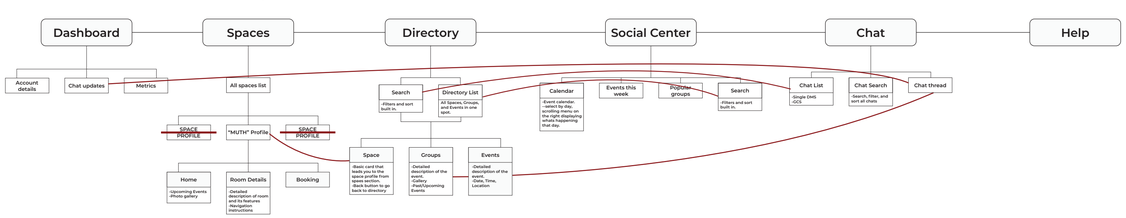


Iteration 2: Persistent Navigation
Introduced a sidebar menu to ensure core actions—Booking, Connect, and Account—are always accessible. This eliminated "Selection Fatigue" by removing hidden sub-menus in favor of direct, on-page action buttons.



Iteration 3: Brand Convergence
Explored experimental colors (Purple/Grey) to modernize the look, but ultimately revealed that maintaining the "Rideau Red" was essential for institutional trust and visual recognition within the community.



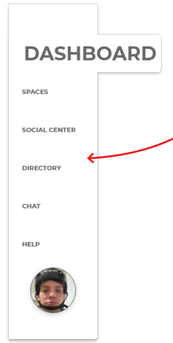


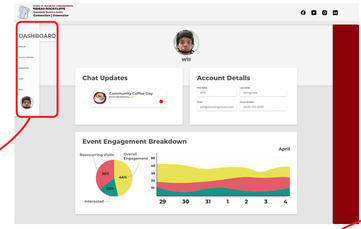
Site Features

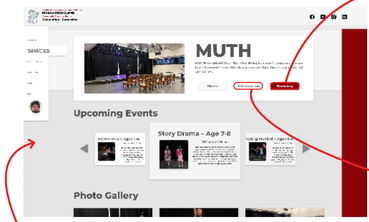
Immediate Access: Persistent, sitewide navigation prioritized by user utility (Dashboard, Spaces, Directory, etc.).

Seamless Experience: Eliminates digging through sub-menus to find core communication and account tools.

Visual Feedback: Navigation titles utilize responsive typography, dynamically scaling to indicate the active section.

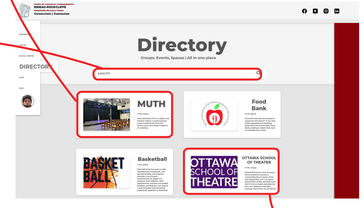


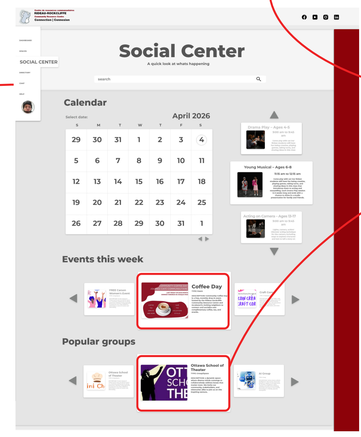


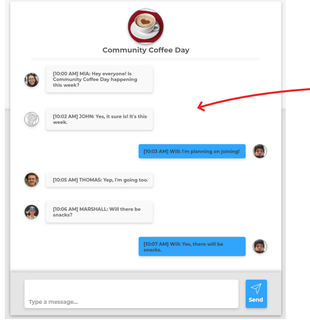




This search interface facilitates efficient navigation by allowing users to systematically sort and filter events, groups, and spaces within their designated categories.



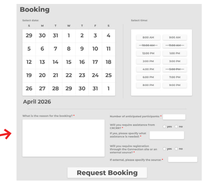




Native Communication Hub: Facilitates seamless, on-platform dialogue between individuals and groups.

Eliminating External Dependencies: Removes the friction of relying on third-party apps like Facebook or WhatsApp for community coordination.

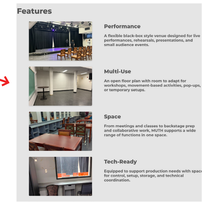
Streamlined Collaboration: Allows users to move instantly from booking a space or joining a group into active, dedicated conver-



Centralized Request System: Transforms community access by replacing traditional administrative hurdles with a clear, on-platform booking request process.

At-a-Glance Availability: Makes every open time slot and resource visible upfront, allowing users to plan confidently before requesting.

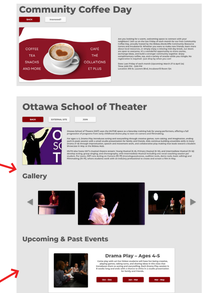
Unlocking Dormant Potential: Encourages spontaneous community initiatives by providing a highly visible, accessible path to utilize versatile center assets.



Visual Discovery: Serves as a descriptive bridge for new users, showcasing a room's potential to remove the "fear of the unknown."

Highlighting Capabilities: Previews specific amenities—like the MUTH's technical layout or a meeting room's accessibility—before the booking process begins.

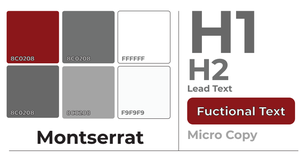
Inspiring Action: Transforms empty rooms into tangible opportunities, empowering community members with the confidence to book their own workshops and gatherings.



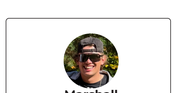
Transparent Group Profiles: Showcases local organizations (like the Ottawa School of Theatre) with clear descriptions, activity histories, and external links.

Digital Bridge to Belonging: The "Join" feature fosters instant connection by directly integrating users into dedicated group communication channels.

Frictionless Event Discovery: Complemented by straightforward event pages that prioritize essential logistics, removing the ambiguity of community involvement.



Average User Journey Map



Marshall
The Occasional Engager

Tech Literacy: Medium (Comfortable with web dashboards, automated chats, and mobile notifications)

Status: A curious but passive community member. He wants to be involved but won't jump through hoops to do it.

Low-Friction Discovery: Wants to easily see "what the hype is about" without digging through complex menus.

Social Validation: Needs to know the vibe of an event (and if there will be snacks) before fully committing his time.



STEP	Landing & Account	Event Discovery	Interst Grab	Chat Navigation	Social Validation	The Commute	Arrival & Participation
SYSTEM ACTION	Loads home dashboard; creates account.	Scrolls Social Center; finds "Community Coffee Day."	Hits the "Interested" button.	Clicks the main "Chats" navigation button.	Enters "Community Coffee Day" chat; asks about snacks.	Day of the event, drives to the community center.	Arrives at the center, enters the building, and joins the event.
TOUCHPOINTS	Authenticates user; redirects to main feed.	Displays "Popular Events" based on community activity.	Automated: Registers attendance + Adds Marshall to the Group UID.	Loads Chat Inbox; prioritizes/bolds "New" chats.	Real-time messaging enabled; pushes notification to others.	Sends an automated chat "Event Starting Soon" push reminder to his phone.	Displays Community Coffee Day on Happening Now.
MARSHALLS ACTION	Dashboard UI.	Event Button / Social Center Feed	Event Detail Page ("Interested" button).	Main Navigation Bar (Chat Icon).	Chat Interface / Message Input.	Physical Car / Mobile Lock Screen (Notification).	Physical Community Center doors / Event Room.
	Inputs basic info to see what the hype is about.	Browses looking for something that catches his eye.	Clicks the button to silently RSVP and get	Moves to the Chats to see who is going.	Types: "Will there be snacks?" and receives a "Yes!"	Gets in his car and uses directions to navigate to the center.	Walks through the doors, recognizes people from the chat, and grabs a coffee.